

The Italian bishop has a target

Opening Decisions

THE IDEA

After 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4, the bishop develops actively and aims toward f7. That pressure supports tactics but does not create a forced win by itself. White still needs a safe king and a central plan.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A quiet setup with d3 supports e4 and develops the c1 bishop gradually. A later d4 break may challenge Black's center. If you aim for a quick attack on f7, count defenders and calculate checks rather than assuming the target is weak enough.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Why is f7 called sensitive in the starting position?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Initially only Black's king defends it. As pieces develop, that can change, and sacrifices there may be unsound. Recount the actual defenders in the actual position.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

A familiar target is an invitation to calculate.